

Rules of Engagement

Engagement Name: Network audit for Smith & Associates

Purpose: Network audit of Smith & Associates within the drafted scope, using only the approved methods, while minimizing risk to business operations and client confidentiality.

Scope of Work

In-Bounds assets:

The following assets are authorized for testing: external IP ranges, named domains, VPN endpoints, public-facing web applications, and internal subnets and/or cloud tenants marked within the scope by Smith & Associates.

Out-of-bounds assets:

The following assets are not authorized for testing, unless expressly approved in writing: archives, backups, HR, legal hold repositories, payroll, production case-management systems, third-party SaaS systems not owned by Smith & Associates, and any Smith & Associates matter data stores not specifically authorized for testing.

Any additional work that may be requested will be discussed, and upon approval, new RoE and additional PTT will be drafted.

Methods

Allowed methods: Authenticated vulnerability assessment, controlled port and service enumeration, limited exploitation to prove impact, packet capture on approved segments only if they don't cause service disruptions, and passive recon.

Forbidden methods: Credential theft beyond approved test accounts, data exfiltration outside of controlled proof, denial-of-service testing, destructive payloads, persistence, physical intrusion, ransomware simulation, and social engineering without separate written approval.

Data handling

Client data: If sensitive or privileged data is encountered, do not copy more than needed to prove the issue, and do not open unrelated contents. Store any evidence decrypted at rest and in transit, restrict access to the smallest necessary group, label it confidential, and delete or return it at the end of the engagement unless a legal hold or written retention obligation applies.

LETTER OF AUTHORIZATION

Date: May 25, 2026

To whom it may concern:

Smith & Associates authorizes John Knight to conduct approved network audit activities on behalf of Smith & Associates within the timeframe listed below.

Authorized period

Start: May 26, 2026 - End: June 22, 2026

Authorized scope: The authorization of this network audit is limited to the assets listed in the Rules of Engagement, including only those domains, IP addresses, systems, and locations listed as “in-bounds” by Smith & Associates.

Authorized Activities: The holder of this letter is authorized to perform only the network audit assessment methods approved and listed in the Rules of Engagement, and may not engage in destructive, disruptive, or out-of-scope activity.

Identification: The holder of this letter will carry government-issued identification matching the name listed above.

Verification contacts:

Primary: Smith Smith, Client, (206) 987-0123

After-hours: Associates, Client, (206) 987- 4567

Security notice: This authorization is valid only for the scope, methods, and time period noted above. If verification is needed, please allow reasonable time to contact the listed authorized representative before taking enforcement action.

Signed,

Smith & Associates

(206) 987-0123

ssmith@smithandassociates.org